MIŻIEN Claim Check 117 · Waste, Malta

Did Malta miss its recycling targets?

The European Commission's July 2026 reasoned opinion, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

"…Malta missed the targets for total packaging, paper and cardboard and metals."

European Commission, July infringements package, 8 July 2026

Same page: Malta failed the 50% municipal recycling target "to be reached by 2020"; reasoned opinion INFR(2024)2135.

We downloaded Eurostat's recycling rates and compared them with the targets the Commission names.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

The findings reproduce; one year of one target was met.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

10.9%

Municipal recycling, 2020

Target 50%. Lowest of the EU-27 on Eurostat's indicator; 16.7% in 2024 against 48.1% for the EU-27.

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Years below target, total packaging

40.0%, 36.8%, 30.8% and 43.4% in 2020 to 2023, against 55%. Paper and cardboard also below 60% every year.

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Years below target, metals

27.1%, 13.0% and 15.2% in 2021 to 2023 against 50%. In 2020 it was 57.2%, above target.

2 months

To respond

A reasoned opinion is the second stage. The Commission may then refer the case to the Court of Justice.

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Not on the Commission's list

Eurostat also shows plastics, wood and glass (2022) below target. We cannot say why they are not listed.

FAIR TO SAY

The Commission's findings hold up against Eurostat. A reasoned opinion is the Commission's position, not a court ruling, and we read its summary page, not the decision text.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Commission: the decision text and data for INFR(2024)2135.
- ☐ Government: its reply to the opinion, if published.
- ☐ Readers: this is a procedure, not a verdict of the Court.